

They've got access to a prescreened dating pool. Online matchmaking sites profess to do the same thing, so people spend massive amounts of money to have a bunch of virtual matchmakers find them a match. My question is: Why the hell aren't you using Auntie instead? She's way better at this, and she certainly knows you better than [Match.com](https://www.match.com).

I'm never going to convince you that love has no place in a marriage. If I did, I'd be a hypocrite: I certainly married Linda for love, and we found each other by chance, not through family. But regardless of how you find a mate, money matters. And arranged marriage is a time-tested approach that takes money into account, so it shouldn't be dismissed summarily. It has worked so well for so long. Aren't you at least a little bit curious to see if it could work for you?

FIVE FACTORS ANY GOOD MATCHMAKER LOOKS FOR

Whether or not you solicit the help of your family, it's a good idea to start vetting potential mates like a matchmaker would. The key is to not lose objectivity and to assess the match based on predetermined criteria. I don't care how great your partner makes you feel—there are certain factors that may be working against your chances for success without your knowledge. Here are five factors to consider carefully before marrying.

1. **Homogamy.** That's a fancy word for what the dictionary calls "mating of like with like." Over the years, surveys have shown that a marriage between people from similar sociological backgrounds is more likely to last than a marriage between people from dissimilar backgrounds. People who share similar values, norms and beliefs are believed to have an easier time adjusting to one another.